

Terms of Reference

Pacific Biomedical Engineering Network (PBEN) Meeting

1. Introduction

The Pacific Biomedical Engineering Network forum operates under the auspices of the Directors of Clinical Services (DCS) and Pacific Heads of Health (HoH). Its role is to improve the coordination, collaboration and information sharing between country biomedical engineering divisions as well as regional development partners. The overall aim is to provide PICTs ownership of, and a means to provide inputs into, biomedical engineering services and workforce development in the Pacific region.

2. Role

The PBEN forum's role is to ensure the HoH are provided with clear guidance, advice and support from their DCS to enable them to make informed decisions on priority issues relating to biomedical engineering matters and the development of biomedical engineering services in the Pacific.

3. Operating Principles

Pacific Biomedical Engineers meet as a technical group, providing a governance oversight role for regional functions specifically related to biomedical engineering services and workforce improvement in the Pacific,

- Accountability: members are accountable individually to their respective DCS, and collectively to the HOH
- Efficiency: PBEN forum will ensure meetings, out of session processes, sub-committee arrangements and secretariat arrangements are efficient, with a well-structured agenda, good chairing, and early circulation of meeting papers and reports.

4. Meeting Chair

To ensure the biennial meeting conducts its business in an efficient and effective manner. It is proposed the following be adopted with regard to chairing the meeting.

a. Chairperson

The country hosting the Pacific Health Ministers Meeting chairs the PBEN meeting.

b. Vice Chairperson

The Deputy Chair will be the country hosting the last Pacific Health Ministers Meeting.

This will ensure that a strong link with the HoH meeting is maintained and continuity in sharing institutional knowledge from one outgoing to incumbent chairpersons.

5. Membership

Membership of the PBEN forum will consist of the biomedical engineers and technicians from PICTs. Development partners and stakeholders will be invited as observers.

6. Attendance

PICTs are encouraged to send the Heads of Department or a representative to the biennial PBEN meeting.

7. Responsibilities

The PBEN will:

- a. Make recommendations on technical and policy issues, and strategic directions for biomedical engineering services and workforce development in the region to the HoH,
- b. Provide and encourage a mechanism for networking between biomedical workforce from PICTs, development partners and service providers,
- c. Support efforts geared at pooling of resources and coordinating assistance to meet shared needs,
- d. Provide a mechanism for information sharing and transfer of best practises between countries,
- e. Review the progress of implementation and ensure full accountability to PICs review and approve work plans, budgets and reports.

8. Meeting Schedule

The PBEN forum will meet biennial, prior to the DCS. This is to enable the secretariat to prepare PBEN recommendations and other papers/presentations for the DCS meeting.

9. Secretariat arrangements

Secretariat services for the PBEN will be provided by the Pacific Community (SPC).

10. Review of Terms of Reference

The PBEN forum shall retain the right to review and amend the ToR periodically.